heavyweight champion

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/45128383.

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by n7punk

Summary

Normally Adora handles alcohol well, and at an average event she even avoids it, so Catra hasn't had to deal with her while she's truly wasted before. It's a good thing, too, because apparently her instinct while drunk is to run off and make Catra hunt her down.
(Or, drunk Adora in the garden)

Notes

Okay I wrote the angsty alcohol fic now y'all get the fun, floppy Adora fic a few years down the line when everybody is better adjusted.

See the end of the work for more notes

The problem with Adora is she is *not* a lightweight. Sounds great, right? She can drink a glass of champagne or whatever else at a function to be polite and Catra doesn't have to worry about it affecting her at all. If Catra doesn't see her do it, Adora always makes sure to warn Catra that she did it so she's braced for her alcohol breath. Adora won't even try to initiate a kiss on her own for the rest of the evening, ever the attentive partner.

The problem with not being a lightweight is Adora can take a second glass no problem, too. And a third. And pretty soon she's losing count because she feels damn near invincible when it comes to drink until she takes one sip too many and it all crashes down around her head. Or rather, it crashes down around her friends' heads. Adora doesn't feel any consequences, instead drifting out peacefully on the waves, giggling and ignoring her friends calling after her.

"Hey there. You look familiar," Catra says in the voice she uses on the babies people ask She-ra to kiss. Adora lolls her head back to look up at her from the floor. Her face is flushed red and her neck is at an angle that looks so uncomfortable it's kind of hard to swallow just looking at it. Catra crouches down next to Adora, close enough to lunge for her but far enough to not spook her if she's as gone as Catra thinks she is. Luckily, Adora drops her chin to keep tracking Catra, returning her spinal column to an acceptable position.

"I'm sure you're mistaken," Adora giggles back. Her words are slurry, but the giggling is what really gives away how gone she is. And the fact she doesn't recognize Catra. Then again, her gaze is so unfocused Catra might as well be any other angry cat – or any other species with ears and a tail, really. The fact she doesn't recognize her voice is a lot less justifiable, especially considering how much Adora likes it.

"Who, I'm pretty sure you're the girl who ran off. All her friends are looking for her and they gave me your description. Pretty memorable," Catra replies. Three years ago, the first time she was introduced to drunk Adora, she never thought she would be talking to

her utterly wasted wife with such fondness, but Catra was prepared for Adora to drink tonight and despite having to chase her down, it is kind of funny how wasted Adora is.

This is what they get for letting her into the wine that arrived from off-world. *Somebody* checked its composition to make sure it was safe to drink before tonight, but apparently First Ones are just different enough that Adora was doing her usual two-drinks-in-and-invincible thing and no one expected the third to hit her that hard. Catra was expecting tipsy Adora when Adora decided to drink tonight. The Adora making comically wide eyes and trying to glance around, only to catch her head in her hands when it obviously spins too fast, is probably five regular drinks past *tipsy*.

"You cant turn me in," she whines, like a five-year-old. She's *so* cute, and so lucky this isnt a few years ago, because if Adora had gotten wasted, bolted, and forgot who Catra was, she's pretty sure her panic attack would have knocked her out cold. Instead, Catra hums, amused, as she shifts a bit closer. Adora watches her with one squinting, unfocused eye as she leans her head into her hand.

"Turn you in, huh? What law did you break?" Catra asks, finally dropping her crouch to settle right beside Adora. She doesnt think her wife is at risk of running off again. Really, no one knows if she was capable of running when she disappeared in the first place, Bow just turned around while he was supposed to be watching her and she was gone. Considering her current state, Catra is pretty sure Adora just wondered off after a firefly or something. There's no reason for her to think she's in trouble, so this is likely as much a fiction as the fact they dont know each other is.

"They're gonna bring me back to my wife." Oh, this is going to be *so* much fun. Catra grins as Adora sulks, looking down at her hand and picking at the edge of a tear she put in her dress right around the knee. Catra doubts Adora knows why it's there while drunk and she definitely wont once she's sober. Long dresses arent compatible with drunk She-ras, apparently.

"Oh, yeah? What's wrong with that?" Catra questions, managing not to let her shoulders shake. She is, once again, *so* glad this is the first time Adora has gotten this drunk. She would have panicked if she heard Adora saying she didn't want to be around her a few years ago. Adora whines and slumps down the wall some, closing her eyes and tipping her face up towards the ceiling of the covered walkway.

"She's gonna *worry*. I don't wanna ruin her night. I'm just gonna sit here and sober up and then she won't-" Adora hiccups, "-have to worry about me," Adora says, like it's the end of the world and she's on the verge of tears about worrying Catra. Catra's heart squeezes with fondness, the vice grip Adora has on it as strong as ever. Gently, she reaches out and places her hand on Adora's shoulder, helping to push her back up where she was starting to list off to the side.

"You don't think she's worried about you missing?" she tries to cajole. As cute as – essentially – toddler-Adora is, Catra would like to get her back to main party and then into one of the castle sitting rooms, preferably. She's pretty sure all the way back up to their room isn't going to be happening without a few hours of sobering up first. They're probably going to sleep on a chaise lounge.

"She doesn't know," Adora mumbles, *it's* apparently a lost cause with her slurring, "She's celebrating and our friends won't worry her until they've found me. She can keep having fun until I'm back," Adora says, looking up again and squinting at Catra as Catra tips her head back and laughs. Yeah, *no*. She knows why drunk Adora might think that Glimmer and Bow would scramble to look for her first before panicking Cara, but in reality she already knew Adora was wasted. When she came back from a quick conversation with the ambassador who so generously gifted them the alcohol, Bow was already searching for Adora.

"Adora," Catra says, her voice fond as she reaches a hand out to Adora's jaw so she can direct her to look at her. To her surprise, Adora makes an offended gasp and – tries to – slap her hand away. It mostly feels like Adora dragging her limp hand down her arm

"I'm *married* and I love my wife very much," Adora says, indignantly, puffing herself up a little and wriggling to sit up better with the aid of the wall. She's *pouting*. Catra wants to kiss that pout right off her face, she loves this woman so much, but that would be a bad idea for many, many reasons, starting with how Adora would think she's cheating on her and ending with Catra, as aroused as she is by this, not being a big fan of alcohol or smelling it on her partner's breath.

"I love you too, Adora. Now will you come back with me so I can show Glimmer and Bow I found you? All of us were worried," Catra tells her, smiling to herself when the words make Adora squint at her and duck her head forward, getting closer as if that will help her eyes focus. After a moment of wavering closer, however, her eyes go wide and she gasps.

"Catra! Is that you?" she half-shouts, half-slurs. Catra is laughing too hard to reply before Adora has thrown herself forward and hooked her arms over Catra's shoulders. Catra's shoulders shake as she hurries to support Adora, desperately hoping the movement wasn't too fast and Adora isn't going to be sick. She hasn't been sick yet in the handful of times she has actually drank enough to get tipsy or drunk in the last few years, but she has *never* been this drunk before.

"Hey, Adora," Catra purrs in Adora's ear once she has tapered off to just a few chuckles. Adora sighs *dreamily* over her shoulder.

"I love you so much. I wanted you to be happy so I went away but I missed you *so much,* I'm so glad you're here," Adora rushes out, barely a breath between her words. Catra's chest feels like fireworks. She has gotten used to the feeling, over time, and she manages to contain her love to just turning her head and pressing a kiss into Adora's hair.

"I love you too. But Adora? I'm always happier when I'm with you. I didn't want you to go away," Catra assures her gently. She understands why Adora's drunk-logic thought this was a good idea, at least once she forgot that Catra already knew she was drunk – or

more likely, she somehow thought Catra hadn't noticed it because Adora is clearly *so capable* of acting normal right now – but she needs to cut off that kind of thinking wherever possible.

Adora makes a noise like a happy, but dying, whale. Her shoulders sag with the effort and her arms tighten around Catra's neck. They both keep up with their workout routines, but Catra's back is starting to get tired hunching over like this.

"Okay, time to get up, big girl," Catra encourages, patting Adora's side where she can reach it and doing her best to position herself so she can prepare to stand. Adora whines against her neck and tugs on her, trying to pull her into her lap. It is just *so unfair* that Adora is attuned enough with She-ra now that she can access a small bit of her strength when she wants for momentary bursts like this. Catra barely avoids bashing her knees in as she tumbles into Adora's lap. Adora could use that strength to walk back up the garden paths to the party but *no*, she uses it to pull Catra into her lap so she can cuddle her.

"Wanna stay here with you," Adora complains, rubbing her face against Catra's neck, pretty much the only part of her Adora can access given Catra actually has her shirt buttoned up beneath her suit jacket for once. She only did that because drunk Adora was eyeing her neck in a way that Catra knew meant she wanted to leave a hickey, so it's really Adora's own fault that she doesn't have better access to Catra's skin right now.

Catra sighs, lifting her hands and placing them on Adora's shoulders. She could insist they get up. If she makes her voice firm, Adora will listen to her no matter what state she's in. The problem is she might think she upset Catra and start crying. There's also the problem of how Catra is going to get them back to the party – and especially into the castle without causing a scene – given how confident she is in Adora's inability to walk in a straight line right now.

Catra reaches out for Melog mentally. They all split up to look for Adora, trying to cover more territory, and Melog takes the news that

Catra has found Adora with a grateful purr in the back of her mind. Melog will hunt down their friends and let them know that Catra has found Adora. After that, they'll come find them so they can help Catra get Adora back to the castle once Adora is stable enough – and willing – to walk.

"Okay , we can stay here for a little," Catra promises Adora, her voice soft. The noise Adora makes is beyond delighted, like a small child being told they can have the entire cake to themselves *and* a pony. Or like Adora being told that, because she really acts the same as a kid sometimes. Side effect of never getting to be one. It's so cute how happy she is to just keep cuddling Catra, and she chooses to show it by peppering the side of her neck with kisses. Whether because she wants to or because she's drunk and not in great control of her mouth, though, those kisses are a bit *sloppy* and only get more open-mouthed as she reaches the edge of Catra's collar and tugs on it, whining with *distress* over not having more access.

"Whoa there, big girl," Catra chuckles, reaching up and gently pulling Adora's hand away. "You're a little too drunk for that. Try again in the morning," Catra tells her, keeping her voice kind as she cradles Adora's head and lifts it so she can look in her eyes. Adora's face is flushed and her eyes have a distinct *nobody's home* look to them, but Adora still pouts up at her and Catra feels bad because she never learned how to say no to Adora's puppy-dog eyes. Adora should have just tried *this* back during the war.

"We can cuddle as much as you want, princess, just keep your hands to yourself," Catra promises her. Adora lets out that delighted squeal again and wraps her arms around Catra with an endearing amount of enthusiasm, hauling Catra close so she can bundle her up in her lap. Catra laughs, nuzzling their cheeks together as she settles down in Adora's arms. Who knows how long she'll have to babysit before Adora is in a state to walk back, but it's not so bad to cuddle her wife who loves her a stupid amount out under the stars.

Catra is still going to mock her relentlessly for this tomorrow, though. It's what she deserves for worrying her.

End Notes

Related fic: floppy (Catra's anxiety with alcohol explained and first time meeting floppy Adora).
I said in the notes of that fic that Adora wasn't actually a lightweight. I think lightweight Adora is a pretty common headcanon because... well, look at EP6, and White Out, but just because she's a sloppy drunk doesn't have to mean it's easy to get there. I like the headcanon that Etherian alcohol doesn't do all that much for her with the First One + She-ra combo. In modern AUs this girl is schwasty though lol
The She-ra strength bursts thing will return in later fics as I have headcanons.

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